Quote 1 – John Andrews, Studies in Photography (1892), Page 8

1. What constitutes “artistic feeling” in Andrews's framework?

Artistic feeling is the ability to see beauty, express emotions, and use creativity when making artwork. Andrews suggests that being an artist requires more than knowing how to use tools or equipment. An artist needs imagination, personal expression, and an understanding of what makes an image meaningful. Artistic feeling is what allows someone to create something that connects with the viewer instead of simply producing a picture.

2. How does this internal sensibility transform a purely mechanical routine into an authentic artistic process?

Artistic feeling turns a mechanical process into art by allowing the artist to make creative decisions. For example, a photographer can simply take a picture, but an artist thinks about lighting, angles, composition, and the emotions they want to express. These choices make the photograph more personal and meaningful. Instead of just recording what is in front of the camera, the photographer uses creativity to tell a story or communicate a feeling.

Quote 2 – Ralph Waldo Emerson, Cited by John Andrews, Page 12

1. Using the metaphor of an alembic, explain what art is according to Ralph Waldo Emerson and John Andrews.

According to Emerson's metaphor, art is nature transformed through human creativity and imagination. An alembic is a tool used to separate and transform substances, so comparing it to art suggests that artists take inspiration from the natural world and turn it into something meaningful. Andrews uses this idea to show that art is not just copying nature exactly as it appears. Instead, the artist adds personal thoughts, feelings, and creative choices to create something unique.

2. If nature provides the raw input, what specific intellectual, emotional, or aesthetic transformation occurs within the “alembic of man”?

The transformation happens when an artist takes something ordinary from nature and gives it a deeper meaning through personal interpretation. The artist uses imagination, emotions, and creative decisions to decide what should stand out. For example, two photographers could take pictures of the same sunset, but one might focus on the bright colors while the other focuses on the shadows to create a lonely feeling. Even though the subject is the same, their different perspectives create different artwork.

Quote 3 – Philip Gilbert Hamerton, Cited by John Andrews, Page 12

1. Why does Philip Gilbert Hamerton assert that photography can never advance beyond the recording of "plain facts"?

Hamerton believed that photography was mainly a mechanical process that captured what already existed in front of the camera. He saw photographs as useful for documenting people, places, and events, but he did not believe they involved the same artistic creativity as painting or drawing. From his perspective, the camera recorded reality rather than allowing the artist to fully transform it through imagination and personal expression.

2. What essential threshold must a medium cross to qualify as a "fine art" under Hamerton's criteria?

Based on Hamerton's argument, a medium must involve more than accurately reproducing reality to be considered fine art. It should allow the artist to express creativity, emotions, and personal ideas. Fine art should communicate something meaningful rather than simply document what exists. Hamerton believed traditional art forms such as painting allowed greater artistic interpretation, while photography depended too heavily on a mechanical device.

3. Contrast Hamerton's critique with Emerson's alembic: does photographic technology pass nature through human consciousness, or does the optical mechanism bypass human distillation entirely?

Hamerton believed that photography relied too much on the camera's mechanical process, which limited the artist's ability to transform nature creatively. Emerson's idea suggests that art happens when people use their imagination and emotions to turn nature into something meaningful. I think photography can fit Emerson's idea because photographers still make important decisions about lighting, angles, timing, and composition. Even though the camera captures an actual scene, the photographer decides how that scene will be presented. For example, a photograph of

an empty road could communicate loneliness or freedom depending on how it is taken. This shows that photography can involve both technology and artistic expression.